



APRIL 22
LEARNING A NEW TOPIC

TOPICS AND LEARNERS

- Owen: The French revolution
- Sneha: Weightlifting
- Stefany: Planets
- Tian'ao: "Realism in International affairs" (theory)
- Ariyana: How to replace a spare tire
- Michael: Different types of compact objects
- Arsh: Soccer preparation for the world cup 😊
- James: What factors affect the flavor of coffee
- Amaury: Old Japanese Cinema: Akira Kurosawa

LET'S CHECK HOW GOOD CHATBOTS WERE AS TEACHERS BY ANSWERING THESE PRE-DESIGNED QUESTIONS

Owen: The French revolution

1. Was Louis XVI ultimately responsible for the initial kickoff of the revolution in 1789, or did he simply inherit a system which was already on the precipice of revolution?
2. What were the primary outcomes of the revolution (post Napoleon); ie how did life for the average French citizen change from the mid 1780's to ~1820's
3. How is the revolution viewed differently between those who would analyze it in the 1900's vs those who analyze it today - and if they differ, how do those differences reflect the accuracy of society's view of the revolution?



Sneha: Weightlifting

1. Not counting diet or weight lifting itself, what is the single most important factor for development (increased performance/muscle mass/etc.) to occur from weight lifting?
2. In terms of sets and repetitions, what is the broad, but fundamental, guiding principle that results in performance increase?
3. How do you distinguish between training hard (training with high effort and maximal results) and over-training (training too much to the point of diminishing returns or actively hindering development)?



Stefany: Planets

Name one planet that is next to Earth?

What is the scientific name for planets closer to the Sun and the others farther away based on general composition?

What is the name of the zone in which habitable planets are found within a solar system?



Tian'ao: "Realism in International affairs" (theory)

- What is realism in IR?
- What were some of the origins of realism in IR?
- What are some examples of realism in international affairs? (Historical or current, either one)



Ariyana: How to replace a spare tire

1. What's the typical tool we can find in the trunk.
2. Where to put the old tire when installing the spare tire to add more safety.
3. Where to put the jack for support.

Bonus q (answer slightly personal):

What 2 extra things are always helpful in case the screw is too tight (strong tape and a long rod to extend the range of the wrench)?



Michael: Different types of compact objects

1. What causes a compact object to form?
2. Why are some compact objects denser than others?
3. What are the (relative) sizes of each compact objects?



Arsh: Soccer preparation for the world cup 😊

Questions:

- 1.What are the rules of soccer
- 2.Where are the games being played for the world cup?
- 3.How is it decided who wins the world cup?



James: What factors affect the flavor of espresso shots

1. If your espresso tastes too acidic or sour what are some potential causes, and how would you change the grind setting for a smoother shot?
2. If someone wanted rich, chocolatey, deep flavor notes, what are some key words you would look for from the coffee itself/how would you best get those flavors when pulling?
3. If you wanted a coffee that had fruit-forward, almost fermented flavors which pre-processing methods would you look for on the label on your coffee bag and what would be a good method for pulling it?



Amaury: Old Japanese Cinema: Akira Kurosawa

1. How does Kurosawa's adaptation of western novels affect Japanese cinema domestically and its reception internationally?
2. What is your take on the movies 'Rashomon' and 'Dreams'?
3. What new camera/lighting techniques did he introduce which were novel and different than other contemporary directors?

REFLECTION (PLEASE ADD IT TO OUR SHARED DOC)

- Based on the Q/A, how would you rate the introduction to your topic you received?
- How would have you carried out this task (learning about your topic) without Gen AI?
- What were the pros and cons?
- Do you feel that you had to "give up" something in this process, or that you gained something?

READINGS FOR NEXT WEEK (PICK ONE)

Scientists invented a fake disease. AI told people it was real

<https://www.nature.com/articles/d41586-026-01100-y>

Take a look at two (of many) autonomous end-to-end research systems

<https://github.com/HKUDS/AI-Researcher> (you can install it, or play with the "production-ready version")

<https://denario.readthedocs.io/en/latest/#last-updates>

The More You Automate, the Less You See: Hidden Pitfalls of AI Scientist Systems

<https://arxiv.org/pdf/2509.08713>

and

The vibe grad student

<https://www.anthropic.com/research/vibe-physics>